SINGAPORE UNIVERSITY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES

MKT202

Proctored Online Exam - July Semester 2025

Marketing Management

Wednesday, 12 November 2025 10:00 am - 12:00 pm

Time allowed: 2 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO STUDENTS:

1. This examination contains **2** questions.
2. Answer all parts of each question in the corresponding answer box.
3. For Section A you must answer **2** out of the **2** questions.
4. All answers must be typed in the answer box and submitted in Examena.
5. This is an **Open-Book** examination.
6. To prevent plagiarism and collusion, your submission will be reviewed by Turnitin. The Turnitin report will only be made available to the marker and you will not be able to view it.
7. The University takes plagiarism and collusion seriously, and your Turnitin report will be examined thoroughly as part of the marking process.

At the end of the examination.
To end the examination, please click on the "Submit and end exam" button to submit your answers.

THE UNIVERSITY RESERVES THE RIGHT NOT TO MARK YOUR SCRIPT IF YOU FAIL TO FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS.

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(Full marks: 100)

Section A (100 marks)
Answer all questions in this section.

Question 1

How influencers, marketing and collectible culture fuel Prime's popularity in Singapore

The glass doors of candy and confectionary store SGFR in Wisteria Mall constantly revolve with a steady stream of customers. Most are in school uniform, and there are excited whispers as they browse a bountiful selection of imported candy, cookies and chips. But it is the fridge at SGFR's newly-opened fifth outlet which sees the most action.

Here, the colourful bottles of the Prime Hydration drink are the main draw. They come in a variety of options such as Blue Raspberry, Metamoon and Lemon Lime and student prices for some flavours start from S$7.50 per bottle.

In a widely shared Facebook post earlier this week, supermarket chain NTUC FairPrice announced it was selling several flavours of Prime Hydration at selected FairPrice Finest outlets. Created by social media influencers and YouTubers Logan Paul and KSI in 2022, Prime has skyrocketed in popularity since.

The brand's first offering was Hydration, a sports drink which is caffeine-free and contains coconut water and electrolytes. It eventually rolled out its Energy line which is sold in cans and has been known to have high caffeine content.

One reason behind Prime's rise is the "significant promotion" from influencers, said Dr Dianna Chang, a senior lecturer of marketing at the Singapore University of Social Sciences. These individuals wield influence over today's consumers, particularly the young, she added.

And with huge global fan bases adding up to nearly 50 million subscriptions, Briton KSI and American Paul have the perfect launchpad for a viral product, said Ms Sau Yee Leung, a senior lecturer at Singapore Polytechnic's school of business. "They also have a foot in various areas teenagers are passionate about, from boxing, gaming to music and more," she explained. "Everyone wants to be part of the conversation around Prime to be seen as the in' crowd. Influencers and celebrities sharing their own content when they get their hands on Prime drinks create further virality."

Prime has signed deals with footballer Erling Haaland, American football quarterback Patrick Mahomes and mixed martial arts champion Israel Adesanya among others. It has also partnered with big football clubs like Arsenal and Barcelona.

Teenagers who spoke to CNA said it was not uncommon to see their peers bringing Prime Hydration bottles to school. "I have a friend ... he would do anything just to get one Prime bottle," said Cyrus Daryoush. "He was willing to pay someone S$20 for an empty bottle."

Cyrus was first introduced to Prime by a neighbour. After trying a few flavours, he too became a fan. "Last year I bought them and I still have some bottles in my fridge right now ... (I am) savouring it, every last drop," added the 11-year-old, who saves pocket money to buy the drink.

(Adapted for academic purposes from:

https://www.channelnewsasia.com/singapore/prime-energy-drink-influencers-hydration-ntuc-sgfr-4059161)

Question 1a

Examine **two** ***(2)*** types of differentiation strategy Prime uses to differentiate from other sports drinks. Provide relevant examples to illustrate your answer.

(14 marks)

Question 1b

Explain **one** ***(1)*** cultural and **one** ***(1)*** social factor that may influence a consumer to buy Prime hydration or energy drinks.

(16 marks)

Question 1c

Propose **two** ***(2)*** communication tools that Prime can employ to increase sales. You need to provide sufficient elaborations and justifications for how you may leverage the selected tools.

(20 marks)

Question 2

After China, Zara expands live shopping experiment to Europe and US

Zara will expand its live shopping broadcasts to the UK, Europe and the United States this year, testing a format that is already wildly popular in China but one with which Western shoppers are less familiar.

Five-hour long live shopping shows in China, broadcast weekly on Douyin, TikTok's Chinese sister site, have helped boost Zara's sales since they launched in November, according to retail analytics firm EDITED.

"We want to take this to the Western countries, where livestream is not as popular...but we think why not – from an entertainment perspective this is like an evolution," said a Zara spokesperson for the initiative, which is expected to launch between August and October.

Shopping as entertainment isn't new - TV shopping channels where viewers phoned in to buy featured products were popular for decades - but social media and ecommerce have triggered a new era of livestreaming, led by China where influencers sell everything from cosmetics to snacks at a frenetic pace.

Brands looking to create a more rarified experience have sought to do live shopping differently. Zara's show on Douyin features Chinese models wearing Zara dresses, trying on shoes and jewellery. It also includes catwalk sequences and "backstage" make-up shots, while its conversational, leisurely style is in contrast to the hard-sell livestreams that hosts like "Lipstick King" Li Jiaqi are famous for.

"Zara's livestream approach built significant brand awareness in China," EDITED

analyst Krista Corrigan said. Zara sold out of most sizes in 50% more products in China in the first three months of this year than in the same period of 2023, according to EDITED data. The livestream also allows Zara to reach shoppers even as its physical presence in China has shrunk from 570 stores in 2019 to just 192 as of Jan. 31 this year. In the UK, U.S. and still to be announced European countries, Zara has chosen to host live shows on its app and website instead of a third-party social media platform to ensure control over aesthetics.

Alfonso Segura, who runs Barcelona-based fashion retail consultancy TFR, said this would also allow it to boost engagement and leverage its database of registered users. Aiming for a "friendly, casual and fun" experience, the shows will be shorter than those on Douyin, lasting 45 minutes to an hour, but viewers will still be able to react in real time with questions, comments and emojis.

"We can't always read across what has worked in China, to whether that's going to work in western Europe or in the UK," said JP Morgan analyst Georgina Johanan. "Here in Europe, we don't really like having someone selling something to us aggressively - of course the end goal of a live shopping event is to sell a product, but consumers don't want to feel like they have the obligation to buy," she said. "Offering something the consumer would not normally find in stores is a good idea – you need to make the event special, otherwise why would they join?"

(Adapted for academic purposes from: https://www.reuters.com/business/retail-consumer/after-china-zara-expands-live-shopping-experiment-europe-us-2024-06-03/)

Question 2a

Analyse **two** ***(2)*** macroenvironment forces that may have influenced Zara's decision to offer live shopping broadcast in China and Western countries.

(16 marks)

Question 2b

Discuss **two** ***(2)*** potential benefits for Zara to adopt live shopping from a channel marketing perspective.

(14 marks)

Question 2c

Using customer relationship management (CRM) principles, recommend **two** ***(2)*** ways in which Zara can engage audience during live shopping. Your answer must be explicitly linked to relevant CRM principles/strategies discussed in this course.

(20 marks)

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